A STORYLINE · DECEMBER 2022 – OCTOBER 2026

The Rajpurkar Family Chat

Kandivli ↔ Jacksonville, one message at a time

Drawn from the family WhatsApp group · ~19,700 messages · 5,188 photos · 16 quarters

A draft for family review — corrections and missing stories welcome

TWO HOMES, 9½ HOURS APART

Who is in the story

- **Aajoba** — warm, encouraging, the careful reader of every photo and certificate
- **Aaji** — daily good-mornings, forwards, food-as-love, and many trips
- **Kandivli, Mumbai**: the grandparents' home base
- **Amit** — the runner, photographer and storyteller; 4 am calls home
- **Prajakta** — teacher-certification exams, birthdays, family anchor
- **Dhanesh** and **Yuvan** — robotics, art, hackathons, telescopes
- **Jacksonville, Florida**: the grandsons' world

Names in the chat are merged: "Mummy / Mummy Viva / Prita Rajpurkar" = Aaji; "Pappaji / Pappaji Viva" = Aajoba; "Amit 305 / Amit on Motorola" = Amit

DEC 2022 – OCT 2026

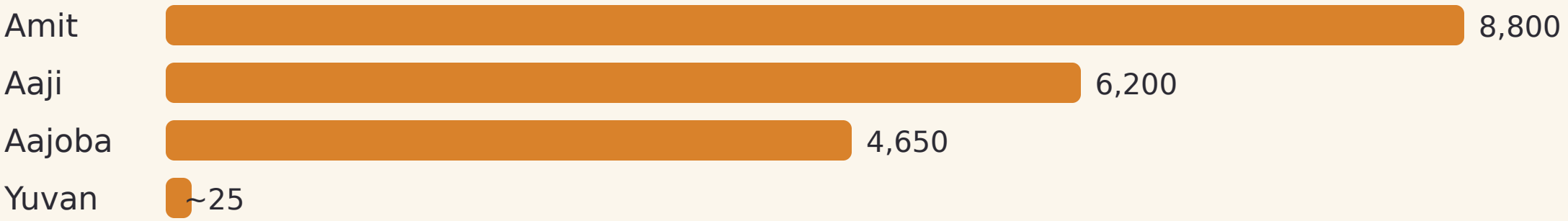
The chat by the numbers

~19,700
messages

5,188
photos shared

~1,075
links

16
quarters



Quiet stretches: 19 Dec 2024 – 19 Jan 2025 (disappearing messages were on). Photos appear from Jan 2025; the 2023 chapters are text only.

THE ANDROID EXPORT FROM THE “AMIT 305” NUMBER

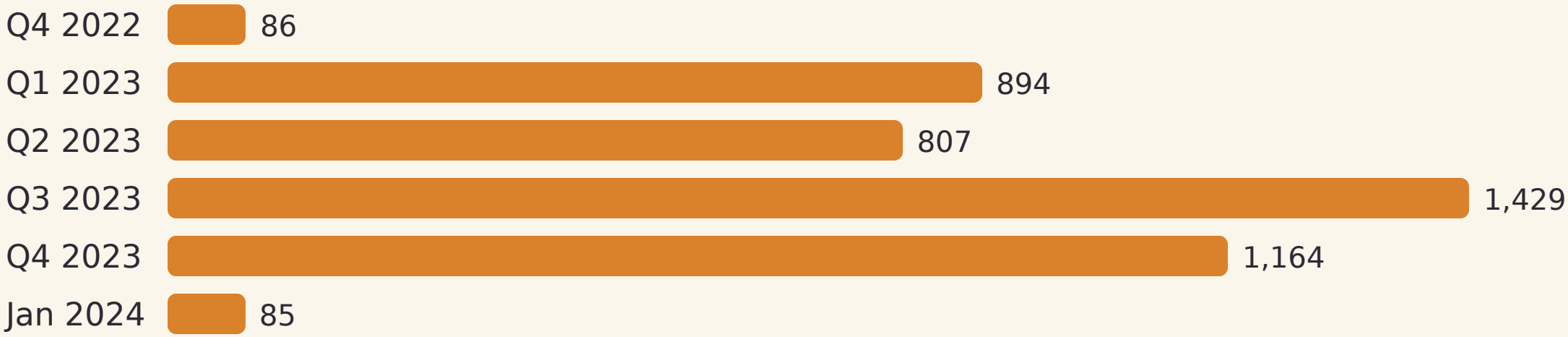
What the second phone added

4,705
new messages

27 Dec 2022
first new message

1 week
of Jul 2025 filled

5 Oct 2026
new last message



Text only — photos and videos appear as “media omitted”. This phone has no messages between 23 Feb and 4 Sep 2026.

Threads that run through it all

- Amit’s running, sleep (“Sleepy today”) and, finally, a triathlon
- The boys’ wins: robotics, SAT/ACT, hackathons, history fair, art contest
- Aajoba and Aaji’s trips across Maharashtra, Gujarat and the Konkan
- Stargazing: comets, eclipses, telescopes, Saturn and Titan
- AI arrives in the family — from a ChatGPT link and “@Meta AI” to Aaji setting an aarti to music
- Festivals kept in two countries, with photos of each naivedya
- Aaji’s daily forwards: devotion, stories, scam alerts, reels
- A teasing, loving tone — and the 4 am phone-call ritual

A DAILY RITUAL ACROSS 9½ HOURS

The 4 am handshake

- Amit’s alarm goes off about 4 am in Florida — 1:30 pm in Kandivli, after the grandparents’ lunch
- “Sleepy” or “I will sleep today” means no call: about 127 such notes between 3 and 5 am
- Or the night before: “Tomorrow morning I will go running, then call you”
- Aajoba: “Take rest.” Aaji: “Zop now sleep” — and a row of hearts
- 18 Feb 2023: the arithmetic spelled out — “my 4:30 am is your after-lunch”
- Calls fail too: “No connection”, “See we talked”, “Call drop zala”
- Photos fill the gaps — running logs, weather, sunsets, the boys’ projects
- The ritual survives into 2025–26, moving to Arattai calls

2023 · Q1

- 27–31 Dec 2022: Amit’s 305 number moves to a Motorola; a freeze warning; ~46 photos “near Atlantis”
- Jan: comet C/2022 E3 (ZTF) — “two comets showing”, Star Walk 2; Aajoba spots the moon
- Amit runs 3–4 miles; 11 Mar: tennis for an hour and a half
- 21 Jan: Dhanesh’s tabla programme; 5 Feb: his birthday; SAT classes at Mirabella
- 14–18 Feb: grandparents in Gujarat — Vadodara, Amul at Anand, Dakor; the failed phone call
- Yuvan the artist: projects, a competition — the judges’ remarks “flattering” (22 Mar)
- 31 Jan: first ChatGPT link; 16 Mar: Silicon Valley Bank explained
- 28 Mar: Amit’s shopping list for the grandparents’ check-in bags

TICKETS, PAPERWORK, RANTHAMBORE AND THE FLIGHT TO JACKSONVILLE

2023 · Q2

- 5–6 Apr: Prajakta buys tickets; Aajoba: “her flight is coming on the same day we are departing”
- 17 Apr: Aaji’s Ranthambore photo album — the trip she missed because of poor health
- 21 Apr: hapus mangoes; 14 May: Mother’s Day; Aajoba’s Chikuwadi garden photos
- 15 May: a bank form for the grandparents; Amit emails the branch and collects passport numbers
- 15–17 May: Yuvan’s Safety Patrol training — “Nice marshal”
- 17 May: Dhanesh scores 80% in Chemistry; Spanish and math exams follow
- 23 May: Mumbai → Dubai → Jacksonville; Amit tracks the plane over Istanbul, France and Canada
- 24 May: “Sitting at the meet-and-greet area near baggage claim”

24 MAY – 24 JUL: THE GRANDPARENTS IN JACKSONVILLE

2023 · The long visit

- The text goes quiet — they share a house — but photo dumps of 30–100 pictures keep coming
- One Google Photos album, “our album”, re-shared four times, to the last day
- 19 Jun: “My sleep times increased since you came here” — Amit’s first charts
- 22–23 Jun: the “Motivation for Pappaji” running clip; wedding-anniversary greetings and dinner
- 14–22 Jul: Lego City, Little Talbot Island, Town Center, Arlington Lions Club Park — “find the crab”
- 20–21 Jul: Yuvan’s “first song” with piano teacher Ms Barbara
- 24–25 Jul: goodbye at the gate; Amit tracks the flight home via Dubai
- 25 Jul: Prajakta drove, Amit on calls, Dhanesh in class — all from the car; “jeera rice is still there”

A NEW CAR, CHANDRAYAAN-3, IDALIA AND GANESHOTSAV

2023 · Q3

- 29–31 Jul: a new car; “finally the real use of the garage”; a second arangetram
- 15 Aug: grandparents at their ashram retreat; 17–22 Aug: Aajoba and Dhanesh’s old iPhone
- 23 Aug: Chandrayaan-3 lands — Amit streams it at 8 am; Aajoba: “Just landed”
- 29 Aug: hurricanes Franklin and Idalia; “50 miles in August” and a first graph
- 5 Sep: Dhanesh finishes his FLVS course — beach and ice cream
- 14–16 Sep: the G20 e-book; Aajoba’s “why learn robotics?” link
- 18–19 Sep: Ganesh Chaturthi — Thane for the grandparents, “virtually” for Amit
- 28 Sep: Amit’s colourful salad lunch — “Jevayla yenar ka??”

PAINTING, AN ECLIPSE, A PARCEL AND DIWALI

2023 · Q4 · Oct–Nov

- 4 Oct: the 305 phone “goes missing” — found in his bag
- 7–21 Oct: Amit takes up drawing; Aaji: “develop this valuable art”
- 14 Oct: the annular eclipse — “it went past Texas into the Gulf of Mexico”
- 15 and 19 Oct: belated birthday wishes for Aajoba; the card — “you should not have spent so much”
- 17–27 Oct: the parcel from Mumbai — sent, tracked, opened with a neighbour on a video call
- 12 Nov: Diwali — “light in the wrong direction”; 19 Nov: “all 4 are looking stunning”
- 16 Nov: Yuvan’s birthday — Aajoba’s dawn greeting, cake photos at night
- 27 Nov: “This visa paperwork is taking me ages!!”

2023 · Dec & early Jan 2024

- 4–9 Dec: Aajoba and Aaji in Varanasi and Ayodhya — Ganga aarti, a double-decker bridge
- 11 Dec: Amit tests “@Meta AI /imagine hummingbird” — not yet live in India
- 14 Dec: Meta’s notice lands in the group; a Ratnagiri family picture “needs a better prompt”
- 17 Dec: Dhanesh’s AP Psychology project; Yuvan’s Christmas party
- 21–29 Dec: an impromptu road trip to Washington D.C.; Aajoba: “Ask Yuvan to take notes”
- 29 Dec: “We reached home” — Aajoba worried; Amit: “I just got tired”
- 1 Jan 2024: Amit’s trip summary — “when will these boys write their memoir?”
- 4 Jan: Aajoba names the women in an old family photo

“ART WITH STEM”, SYDNEY AND A FLORIDA SPRING

2024 · Q1

- 6 Jan: the archive opens — FIRST Robotics season kickoff for Dhanesh’s team
- Ram Mandir week: Aaji’s devotional videos; Amit joins in
- Amit restarts running after a 3-month gap; Aajoba nudges: “no excuses”
- 4–5 Feb: birthdays of Amit and Dhanesh — shrimp dinner in Florida, pizza and omelette from Aaji
- Amit joins Aaji and Aajoba’s yoga “world-record” class to practise together
- Yuvan’s competition rounds; Aajoba: “Yuvi will lead the group next time”
- A family elder passes away (11 Jan)
- Food as love: cabbage pizza vs flower pizza (24–27 Feb)

ECLIPSE, BHUTAN AND THE END OF THE ROBOTICS SEASON

2024 · Q2

- 8 Apr: solar eclipse in Florida; Gudi Padwa; the couple’s 20th year
- Team Robonauts beat Dhanesh’s team in Tallahassee
- Yuvan the artist: ceramic piece, “trash to treasure”, a hallway memory tile, piano recital (13 Apr)
- 19–26 Apr: Aajoba and Aaji travel to Bhutan / the Northeast
- Amit’s workouts: HIIT, 3-mile runs, “1000 free jumps”
- Lok Sabha results week; Borivali picnic and a monsoon bus trip
- 23 Jun: wedding anniversary collage; Aaji offers a second ceremony

HOUSTON, NASA AND A WINNING TEAM

2024 · Q3

- Late Jun–7 Jul: Gulf road trip — New Orleans, Houston, a full day at Johnson Space Center
- 28–29 Jul: Dhanesh’s team wins the SpaceSet competition — “kudos!”
- 18 Aug: Dhanesh drives on a highway for the first time (Fort Clinch)
- Hurricane watches in August and September
- 16 Aug: Aaji joins the chat under a second name (Prita Rajpurkar)
- Prajakta’s birthday lunch; Yuvan’s painted coaster gift
- Amit’s travel diary and the “Summer Vacation 2024” PDF

NAVRATRI, A PARCEL FROM MUMBAI AND DIWALI

2024 · Q4

- The clothes parcel: shopping list, courier tracking, a wrong-address scare — arrives 21 Oct
- Navratri, Dussehra, Diwali, Lakshmi Pujan — mango-pulp modaks and baked carrots
- Dhanesh’s team metal samples reach the International Space Station
- Yuvan’s FLL team (“Bob the Builders”): logo, cards and a Canva site by Amit
- 23 Nov: the tournament at Ponte Vedra; “find Dhanesh in the seating chart” puzzle
- Bhai mama’s hospital stay; family gathers around
- 19 Dec: messages start to disappear — a month-long gap begins

THE ARCHIVE “WAKES UP” WITH PHOTOS

2025 · Q1

- 19 Jan: photos begin; Aaji’s “good news” card; Amit switches disappearing messages off
- Florida at −5 °C: schools close; Aajoba: “you might be experiencing snow in Jacksonville”
- A father–son 5-mile river run (25 Jan) — Aaji: “congratulations both son and father”
- 19–23 Feb: Aajoba and Aaji at Tadoba — two tigers walk past their jeep
- 29 Jan: Amit shares the DeepSeek interview; 10 Mar: the first “@Meta AI” moment
- March: Dhanesh’s team at Tallahassee and the Orlando championship
- 4 Feb: Amit’s birthday; Aaji’s Mahakumbh forwards

STARS, RUNS, HOUSTON, AND A SAT SCORE

2025 · Q2

- 4–5 Apr: UNF astronomy club and NEFAS at Hanna Park
- Mid-Apr: Dhanesh’s team in Houston — “one of the four winning teams”
- 20 Jun: Dhanesh scores 1390 on the SAT (Math 780)
- 24–27 Apr: Kokan trip — Dapoli, Anjarle, Hedvi Ganapati
- 12 Apr: Yuvan’s piano recital; 29 Apr: school trip to NASA
- 9–14 Jun: a week around Orlando with the boys; Tesla-coil presentation
- 22 Jun: anniversary wishes; “21 years ago” Kerala photos

DAMS, A PINHOLE CAMERA, AND GANESHOTSAV TWICE

2025 · Q3

- Jul: Pawana and Mulshi dams; Khadkhad, Dabhosa and Vikramgad trips
- Amit builds a pinhole camera: “the roof is upside down”
- 7–8 Sep: lunar eclipse; Saturn and Titan photographed (27 Sep)
- 16–24 Jul: Amit’s trip — landing videos, a plank, “we reached at 12:35 am”
- 12 Aug: Dhanesh’s viva; 23 Aug: SAT test; Prajakta passes her Florida exam (6 Sep)
- Yuvan reads The Phantom Tollbooth; the “guess the artist” quiz
- 15 Sep: the grandparents see Dashavtar; Amit asks about ShareChat
- 30 Sep: Arattai, the made-in-India messenger, arrives

TELESCOPES, A 5K, GOA, MOUNT ABU, HILTON HEAD

2025 · Q4

- 2 Oct: a loaned NEFAS Dobsonian telescope; 1 Nov: Saturn’s rings
- 24 Oct: Amit runs a 5K in Jacksonville
- Oct–Nov: Yuvan’s certificates; Dhanesh’s hackathon list; ACT scores
- 13 Dec: a maths-quiz bronze for the school
- 27–31 Oct: Goa; 23–27 Nov: Pandharpur, Akkalkot, Tuljapur with a 30-member group
- 13 Oct: Aajoba rides the new Aqua Line metro
- 20–27 Dec: Mount Abu; 24–27 Dec: Amit’s family at Hilton Head Island
- 30 Dec: Amit’s annual jogging and walking report

A FREEZING WINTER, TWO HACKATHON WINS, UCF

2026 · Q1

- Jan: coldest Florida mornings; feels-like −14 °C
- 29 Jan: Dhanesh’s University of Central Florida acceptance — “superb!”
- 31 Jan–12 Feb: Amit and Yuvan both win certificates in the EMERGE mosquito-data hackathon
- 7 Mar: Yuvan wins second place in the school history fair (National History Day)
- Aaji’s eye operations (Jan) and a good report on 21 Jan
- 14 Mar: Dhanesh’s first solo drive — back after four hours
- 26 Feb: Yuvan finishes a telescope; 18 Feb: first mention of Cowork and OpenClaw
- 28 Mar: Jayu’s birthday; Gudi Padwa; “Dhurandhar 2”, four hours

KONKAN, KAMSHET, HISTORY DAY AND A NEW YORK ROAD TRIP

2026 · Q2

- 10–15 Apr: Konkan tour — Ganpatipule, Dapoli, Suvarnadurga; Orion nebula
- 4–5 May: Yuvan at Florida History Day (Tallahassee) with a coal-mine-safety website
- 13–17 May: Sindhudurg, Malvan, Vingurla, Sawantwadi
- 30 May–17 Jun: “Road Trip 2026” — Newark, NYC, Saratoga, Niagara, Hershey, Raleigh, Savannah
- 19–20 Jun: Dhanesh’s convocation and send-off dinner
- 24 Jun: Amit’s travel-log webpage (15,436 photos)
- 21 Jun: Bhai’s 75th birthday celebrated in Mumbai

DORM ROOM, DASHBOARDS AND A TRIATHLON

2026 · Q3

- 15 Aug: photos of Dhanesh’s dorm room and cycle stand — “must be very happy”
- 27 Sep: dropped Dhanesh back at his hostel at midnight; home at 3 am
- 12 Aug and 28 Aug: a solar eclipse (mostly Europe) and a lunar eclipse in Florida
- 11 Jul: Amit’s car-fuel and running dashboards for Aajoba
- 31 Aug: Amit signs up for a triathlon on 15 Sep; results dashboard on 22 Sep
- 2–7 Aug: Toranmal; 22–24 Sep: Naneghat’s “reverse waterfall”
- 13–14 Aug: Yuvan removed and re-added to the group — a family comedy

Epilogue · early Oct 2026

- 28–29 Sep: Aajoba’s reels; Aaji greets Angarki Chaturthi; Amit offers “alternatives for Granola in India”
- 30 Sep: “That is Yuvan’s work”; a sitar aarti from the Saras Baug Ganpati temple
- 1 Oct: the first-of-the-month run — “a very good pace”
- 3 Oct: Amit at the American Heart Association walk — 21 photos; Aajoba: “Good crowd”
- 2 and 4 Oct: a new sender, apparently Yuvan — 0.1 inches of rain, and a NOAA Ocean Guardian survey for Aaji and Aajoba
- 5 Oct: the last message — Aaji’s Marathi line, cut off mid-sentence

The boys, milestone by milestone

- **Dhanesh**: tabla programme (Jan 2023); FLVS course done (Sep 2023); AP Psychology project (Dec 2023); FRC robotics seasons; SpaceSet win (Jul 2024); Houston (Apr 2025); SAT 1390 (Jun 2025); Hack With The Beat list (Oct 2025); UCF acceptance (Jan 2026); first solo drive (Mar 2026); convocation and dorm (Jun–Aug 2026)
- **Yuvan**: Safety Patrol (May 2023); first piano song with Ms Barbara (Jul 2023); ceramics and hallway tile (2024); FLL team 42240 (Nov 2024); piano recitals; Marine Art Contest win (Dec 2025); EMERGE hackathon (Feb 2026); National History Day — 2nd at school fair, State contest (May 2026); Arduino radar; a homemade telescope

Grandparents on the road

- Feb 2023 — Gujarat: Vadodara, Anand, Dakor
- May–Jul 2023 — two months in Jacksonville
- Dec 2023 — Varanasi and Ayodhya
- Apr 2024 — Bhutan and the Northeast
- Feb 2025 — Tadoba tigers
- Apr 2025 — Kokan and Hedvi
- Jul 2025 — Mulshi, Pawana, Khadkhad dams
- Oct 2025 — Goa
- Nov 2025 — Pandharpur, Akkalkot, Tuljapur
- Dec 2025 — Mount Abu
- Apr 2026 — Konkan, Ganpatipule, Dapoli
- May 2026 — Sindhudurg and Vingurla
- Aug 2026 — Toranmal · Sep 2026 — Naneghat

Amit’s running story

- 2023: 4-mile runs in January, “50 miles in August”, a first year-to-date graph
- 2024: restarts running, 14 min/mile, “1000 free jumps”
- 2025: 5-mile river run; pace logs; a 5K on 24 Oct
- Annual jogging report, 30 Dec 2025
- 2026: freezing winter mornings, then the “old routine” returns in Sep
- 31 Aug 2026: triathlon registration — 1 mile row, 5 mile cycle, 2 mile run
- 22 Sep: a results dashboard Amit built himself

COMETS, ECLIPSES, TELESCOPES

Looking up

- Jan 2023: comet ZTF over Jacksonville — Aajoba: “Comet looks clear”
- 23 Aug 2023: Chandrayaan-3 lands, streamed at 8 am Florida time
- 14 Oct 2023: the annular eclipse; 8 Apr 2024: a solar eclipse and a day off school
- 4–5 Apr 2025: the UNF astronomy club and NEFAS at Hanna Park
- 2 Oct 2025: a loaned NEFAS Dobsonian telescope; 1 Nov: Saturn’s rings
- 27 Sep 2025: Saturn and Titan photographed; 7–8 Sep: a lunar eclipse
- Feb 2026: Yuvan finishes a telescope; 12 and 28 Aug 2026: two more eclipses
- Always with a reply from Aajoba: “Very clear pic”

AI comes home

- Jan 2023: the first ChatGPT link — “could destroy Google’s business”
- Dec 2023: Amit tests Meta AI — hummingbird prompts
- Mar 2025: the first “@Meta AI” in the chat (James Bond question)
- Sep 2025: Gemini portrait experiments; Aajoba shares ChatGPT links
- Oct 2025: a free UNF AI course for the grandparents
- Feb 2026: Cowork, OpenClaw and the “AI is coming so fast” talk
- Sep 2026: Aaji writes an aarti and sets it to music with AI; ChatGPT “1980s look”
- Arattai calls in 2025–26

Festivals in two countries

- Makar Sankranti, Holi, Gudi Padwa (a small gudi in Florida)
- Ram Navami, Akshaya Tritiya, Guru Purnima, Raksha Bandhan
- Ganesh Chaturthi: naivedya from Kandivli, a “chotisi puja” in Jacksonville
- Navratri, Dussehra, Diwali with faral parcels
- Janmashtami prasad sent by photo (Sep 2026)
- Birthdays and anniversaries that cross time zones
- 2023: Ganesh Chaturthi in Thane, Vijayadashami, Diwali rangoli in Jacksonville

What we’d love from you

- Did we get names, places and dates right? Please send corrections.
- Which stories deserve more detail for a future memoir or novel?
- Are there family moments missing from the chat that should be added?
- Anything here you would prefer to leave out?
- Which quarter or trip should become a full chapter first?
- Is the +1 (904) number that appears in Oct 2026 Yuvan’s own phone?
- What were the 2023 visa papers and Prajakta’s April tickets for?
- Where did Amit travel on 16–24 Jul 2025?

THE CHAT IS A FAMILY ARCHIVE. LET’S MAKE IT A BOOK.

Thank you

Draft v2 · October 2026